



THE FIGHT FOR AMERICA'S FAMILIES

Exposing the Corruption in Family Courts and CPS.

They took my kids. They tried to silence me. They WON'T.

FAMILY COURT DATA REPORT · STATE SERIES · NO. 4

ARIZONA

WHAT FAMILIES ARE REPORTING.

Pulled from the Family Rights Registry — the first cross-state dataset on what pro se parents are actually experiencing inside Arizona's family courts and child-welfare system.

41

ARIZONA FAMILIES ON RECORD · 57
CHILDREN IMPACTED · 18 MONTHS
MEDIAN MONTHS LOST OF PARENTING
TIME

REPORT GENERATED
APRIL 28, 2026

COUNTIES REPRESENTED
10 OF 15

COMPILED BY
MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

THE HEADLINE NUMBERS

ARIZONA AT A GLANCE.

Across 41 Arizona families reporting through the Family Rights Registry, the patterns are consistent: long durations in court, serious financial loss, and a disproportionate number of parents going unrepresented because they ran out of money fighting.

CHILDREN IMPACTED 57 40 of 41 families reported child counts	MEDIAN ATTORNEY FEES \$25,000 per reporting family	MEDIAN MONTHS LOST 18 of parenting time	WENT PRO SE 61.0% 31.7% after running out of money
SUBMISSIONS 41	AVG CHILDREN / FAMILY 1.4	FAMILIES REPORTING CHILDREN 40 of 41	COUNTIES REPRESENTED 10

WHY THIS REPORT EXISTS.

On January 29, 2024, I lost custody of all five of my children.

- NO TRIAL.
- NO QUESTIONING.
- NO SUBSTANTIATED ABUSE.

It took only a signature on an ex parte emergency order to erase a mother. I refused to disappear. I fought back, and built the Family Rights Registry so Arizona families — and families in every state — would stop being invisible to the data. This report is their record.

— MEG · [STANDWITHMEG.COM](https://standwithmeg.com)

02 THE COST OF ARIZONA FAMILY COURT

Legal fees are the largest reported expense, but they are not the only one. Lost wages, evaluation costs, and reunification services compound the financial loss — pushing most families toward pro se representation once their savings run out.

EXPENSE CATEGORY	RESPONSES	MEDIAN	MEAN	TOTAL REPORTED
Attorney Fees	29	\$25,000	\$69,310	\$2,010,000
Lost Wages	22	\$30,000	\$75,871	\$1,669,170
Other Court Fees	17	\$0	\$24,529	\$417,000
Therapy / Evaluations	23	\$2,000	\$8,048	\$185,100
Reunification Services	21	\$500	\$2,641	\$55,459
GAL Fees	16	\$100	\$8,831	\$141,300
Asset Loss ¹	23	\$70,000	—	—
Estimated Median Family Impact	—	\$127,600	—	—

Median vs. mean: Median is the middle reported amount, so it better reflects the typical reporting family when a few very large expenses appear. Mean is the average across reporting families and can be pulled higher by outliers.

1. On asset loss: One respondent reported an extreme outlier that skews the mean beyond usefulness. We report the median (\$70,000) and suppress the mean and total, pending data-quality review. Lost Wages also contains wide variance; median is the honest headline.

LOST PARENTING TIME · MONTHS

Median months lost		18	1.5 yrs
Mean months lost		34	2.8 yrs
Total across all families		978	81.5 yrs

03 WHO IS REPORTING · ARIZONA

Most families documenting in Arizona are currently active in, or recently closed out of, long-running cases. Nearly half have lost all contact with their children.

CASE STATUS · SYSTEM AFFECTED

CASE STATUS

Not provided		16	39%
Active case: stuck or delayed		13	32%
Case closed: more than 2 years ago		8	20%
Case closed: within last 2 years		2	5%
I am currently in an active case (progress is being made)		1	2%

SYSTEM AFFECTED

Both Family Court and CPS		18	44%
Family Court Only		14	34%
CPS (Child Protective Services) Only		4	10%
Unknown		4	10%
Family Court		1	2%

DURATION · CUSTODY OUTCOMES

TIME IN SYSTEM

1 – 3 years		15	37%
5 – 10 years		8	20%
3 – 5 years		6	15%
Over 10 years		4	10%
6 months – 1 year		3	7%

CUSTODY STATUS

No Contact / Total Loss of Access		14	34%
50/50 Joint		10	24%
Visitation Only		9	22%
Children in Foster Care		3	7%
Full Custody		2	5%

GEOGRAPHY · ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

TOP COUNTIES

Maricopa		10	24%
Mohave		3	7%
Yavapai		2	5%
Usa		2	5%
Pima		2	5%
Mohave		1	2%

TOP ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

Family Court False Accusations (Domestic Violence/Abuse/Alienation)		13	32%
False Accusations CPS (Non-Medical) (Vengeful ex-partner, malicious report)		8	20%
High Conflict Divorce		5	12%
Other: (Short answer)		5	12%
Medical CPS (Medical Child Abuse allegations, disagreement with doctors)		2	5%

05 PARENT VOICES — ARIZONA

Selected voice excerpts appear here for readability. Every approved, shareable Arizona comment is printed in full in the appendix that follows.



My abusive, dx NPD, undx ASPD, never-working ex, his flying monkeys, corrupt CPS (who ignored court interviewer, kids' teacher, and my kids but should have helped us get free from my ex) and corrupt family court have completely and totally destroyed my children, our loving [...]

— ELISABETH

We have been alienated from each other, I was forced to abandon, because of threats and interigation tactics to my children. I cant control what cps is doing to my children, while I am not present in their life, they have to pretend to hate me to appease the father, court, casa [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Family Court and CPS have damaged the mental health of my children. There should be accountability for Judges, Attorneys, Psychologist, to are not doing what is in the best interest of the Children.

— MANUEL

Destroyed it. Evil abuser had everything granted. Children are abused and I'm controlled

— LAUREN

It has destroyed mine and my wife life and we are still crying and wishing that we could be with him and his brothers and sisters that are younger than he is he will be turning 13 in May. I have three other kids ranging from five years old, and 12 years old and my kids love to [...]

— JOHN

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



Destroyed my family. abused the children. Tortured and extorted me as a father.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My now adult children are now forever traumatized and broken with anxiety and depression from being ripped away from me for a year. After i was their primary caretaker for the first 10 years of their lives.

— MOLLY

Put my children back in the hands of their abuser

— ELIZABETH

It has destroyed the bond with my son and I and placed him in the hands of a felon

— MYKELA

They permanently altered my life and my young 3 sons” lives. Not only did they steal our time, which we will never get back, but they let our abuser walk away without any consequences or accountability. The trauma inflicted on us will never leave our story,

— LACEY

The system has used my family to farm out drug testing, behavior health services and then my daughter was thrown to my abuser even though they knew the circumstances. They were “legal kidnappers” in Havana’s county. The t-shirts they made can still be seen in photos online

— LEIGH

My babies never experienced trauma until they were removed from my home.

— DANIELA

"I survived abuse only to be betrayed by the very system sworn to protect us. Family Court and CPS punish mothers for protecting their children, twisting fear into guilt and love into crime. They can take my children, but they will never take my truth, my voice, or the justice [...]"

— MELISSA

Devastating physical and psychological damage to my son. Years of unimaginable trauma for both us

— MICHELLE

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



They victimized the victim, which was me. I was a victim of dv , abuse, narcissistic control and they came after me. My children's only caretaker. Made my husband a saint.

— DESIREE

Destroyed my family, tore us apart and kept going. it will be s miracle if our parent child relationship is ever restored.

— SUMMER

The pain is beyond words for me, her siblings, grandmother, uncle... friends. Everyday I miss my baby. Everyday I love her.

— WHITTNI

Ignored proof of DV. Took my 9 month old whom I had 95 percent of the time and let the abuser have her 30 percent of the time. I paid off all his bills so I could protect her from 50/50. The abuse didn't end.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Judge Ashley Halvorson and Kolette Butler Psychologist, JD, PsyD seem to be bias to mom. My ex works for the MCBA I am a patient of Teri Hourihan

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Took away the confidence in the only thing I could say proudly and that was "was a good mom"

— REBECCA

The system has disrupted my children's lives. I have stayed on top of fighting what is right, yet, they refuse to make the appropriate best interest findings. My children were gone for 7 months. Missed 40% of a school year because of negligence. They failed to act!

— ERIC

Traumatized me to this day repeteve allegations living in fear tore us apart stole my daughter

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system destroyed me financially, left emotional scars,, but worst of all they took the last piece of my childrens childhood and replaced it with complex trama.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



Az "family" court has devastated me financially. I have been able to avoid bankruptcy only by taking tens of thousands out of my retirement account, borrowing from family and by doing debt consolidation which has ruined my credit. Since I have had over 5 years of only seeing my [...]

— LAURA

My daughter was taken away directly after birth due to having a flat affect. Crazy! My daughter is 26 now. I missed her whole entire life. A cps worker who was young as can be with no kids was in my home telling me how to budget my money. I've never been late on a bill in my [...]

— CANDICE

This has almost destroyed my current marriage and has alienated my baby girl from her 3 other younger siblings and myself (her mom) She is so young. She was in kindergarten. It's hurt all of us tremendously.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Child Protection services? Instead of protection we got seperation, fear and trama. DCS didn't investigate my family they disrupted it, trust was damaged, and the sense of safety was taken away.

— SHEENA

They separated my infant and gave him to the hands of our abuser. Who continues to psychologically manipulate my toddler against me. Our secure attachment was broken, and I have to watch my child suffer and there's nothing I can do about it.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has completely ruined my entire life, my dignity, my self-respect, my right to life...to live in the enjoyment of life, peace, liberty, happiness, and have not only basic necessities but the standard of living I had before. It has left me homeless & below poverty. It has [...]

— ERIKA

After 22 years of trying to come from my daughter they now have kidnapped my granddaughter when my daughter was a rape victim

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

Family court was nothing short of another beating.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I have never been more disrespected and humiliated in my entire life i am 55 years old and have never been away from daughter her entire life up till 18 months ago. This judge has mantly reprimand and told me there are no morals in his courtroom then proceeded to make fun of my [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

32 Arizona parents submitted approved, shareable comments. 32 selected excerpts appear here; the full comments begin on the next page.

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS — ARIZONA

The comments below are the full approved, publicly shareable survey comments from Arizona families. Data-only and do-not-share submissions are excluded from this public appendix.

My abusive, dx NPD, undx ASPD, never-working ex, his flying monkeys, corrupt CPS (who ignored court interviewer, kids' teacher, and my kids but should have helped us get free from my ex) and corrupt family court have completely and totally destroyed my children, our loving parent-child bonds, and me. Their horrible decisions and abuse of power, putting our lives and pets and assets in the complete coercive control of my abusive ex, cost the life of one of our cats and has cost us almost everything my kids and I worked for our whole lives, and may ultimately cost us our lives.

— ELISABETH

We have been alienated from each other, I was forced to abandon, because of threats and interigation tactics to my children. I cant control what cps is doing to my children, while I am not present in their life, they have to pretend to hate me to appease the father, court, casa, lawyers, gaurdian and cps. They have stolen more than words, money or anything that can be bought. The time lost is unimaginable. I wouldn't wish this pain on someone I hated. I cried myself to sleep for the first 2 years. Now im becoming numb to it, because my only choice is to quit, despite what my heart and soul want. In the end, my kids are suffering from this, so much. I hope we can repair and heal someday. Two years ago, when I started this fight, I was very hopeful. Now, im just waiting for them to be 18. Only 1.5 years left. For one child and 3.5 for the other. I have been pushed aside, told to forget about them, told to move on, told im not good enough, I have went to court every 3 months just to be told my kids hate me, despite their attempts to be part of my life. Gaurdian doesnt want that to happen. She thinks she has a relationship with my ex husband. She plans on holding my kids hostage until he is released from prison. So much more to this story. So much corruption, I have witnessed in the court room. With cps, funding and group homes. 4 different judges in 2 years. 2 different attorneys. 1 cps supervisor and 4 different cps workers. Cps worker admits on a recording, that she doesnt write the reports. They dont even know what the realistic allegations are. Im not sure who wakes up on a daily basis, for the purpose of destroying another human. It seems to be a dcs requirement, in

— ANONYMOUS PARENT (1/2)

Mohave County, AZ.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT (2/2)

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It has destroyed mine and my wife life and we are still crying and wishing that we could be with him and his brothers and sisters that are younger than he is he will be turning 13 in May. I have three other kids ranging from five years old, and 12 years old and my kids love to see him. They go to school and see them and sometimes they'll go to their grandma's house and see him, but I cannot have anything to do with my son that CPS took from me. They lied to the court system and I wanted to file a lawsuit on them, but I could not find an attorney to do that because it is hard to fight the government, so nobody wanted to fight the government. I still cry and really concerned about my son. I know he is taking care of by my mother-in-law, but my mother-in-law and father-in-law don't want me to have anything to do with him. I'm not hurts me a lot.

— JOHN

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— LAURA

My daughter was taken away directly after birth due to having a flat affect. Crazy! My daughter is 26 now. I missed her whole entire life. A cps worker who was young as can be with no kids was in my home telling me how to budget my money. Ive never been late on a bill in my entire life. Years later that cps worker was a patient at the psychiatric hospital I worked at. She approached me and apologized. I walked away and never spoke to her.

— CANDICE

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— ERIKA

After 22 years of trying to come from my daughter they now have kidnapped my granddaughter when my daughter was a rape victim

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Family court was nothing short of another beating.

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— ANONYMOUS PARENT

32 full approved Arizona comments are included in this appendix.

07 HOW TO READ THIS REPORT**WHAT THIS IS**

The Family Rights Registry is a national, parent-reported data collection run by Stand With Meg. Every figure in this Arizona report comes from Arizona respondents who voluntarily submitted survey entries about their experience inside family court and/or CPS.

This report is built to help families, advocates, reporters, and legislators see the patterns emerging in Arizona — not to replace formal research, and not to name individual judges or counties as responsible parties.

WHAT IT ISN'T

This is not a representative sample. Respondents self-select. The 41 Arizona families reporting here are not the universe of Arizona families in court — they are the families who found the survey, trusted it enough to submit, and told us what happened to them.

Financial figures are self-reported. We flag outliers and report medians when means are distorted (see page 3, note 1). Quotes are minimally edited.

METHODOLOGY · FAMILY RIGHTS REGISTRY

Data in this report was collected April 2024 – April 2026 through standwithmeg.com/family-rights-survey. Submissions are timestamped. Duplicate-submission heuristics use normalized email + location, with direct survey rows preferred over legacy rows and the newest row retained within each source. Categorical responses from multi-select and short-answer fields are normalized monthly.

When a respondent's financial entry differs from the population by more than three standard deviations, the mean is suppressed and only the median is reported. Lost-wage, attorney-fee, and asset-loss entries are self-reported and not corroborated against tax records or court filings.

Geographic reporting uses the county field as submitted, with light normalization (e.g. "Butte silverbow" → "Butte–Silver Bow"). Quotes carry one of three public permission states: *Anonymous*, *First-name only*, or *Full attribution with consent to public use*. Court actor names appear only after 5 independent families name the same actor.

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ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report is based on self-reported survey submissions collected by Stand With Meg. Counts and categories reflect responses available at the time this packet was generated.

This report is for informational and advocacy use only, not legal advice or an official government record.

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